ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 7 · SET 03

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The Sundarbans, the world's largest mangrove forest, lie in the delta of the —

(A) Narmada (B) Ganga and Brahmaputra
(C) Godavari (D) Indus

> **Ans: (B)** The delta is shared by India and Bangladesh.

(ii) Which of the following is an island group in the Arabian Sea?

(A) Lakshadweep (B) Andaman Islands (C) Nicobar Islands (D) Sundarbans

> **Ans: (A)** Lakshadweep is a coral island group; the Andaman and Nicobar Islands lie in the Bay of Bengal.

(iii) Humidity is the amount of —

(A) water vapour in the air (B) dust in the air
(C) oxygen in the air (D) speed of the wind

> **Ans: (A)** It is measured with a hygrometer.

(iv) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): The Thar Desert of Rajasthan receives very little rainfall.
Reason (R): The Aravalli range lies parallel to the direction of the Arabian Sea branch of the monsoon and does not force the winds to rise.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** Moisture-laden winds pass along the Aravallis without being forced to rise, so there is little rain.

(v) The southwest monsoon season in India lasts roughly from —

(A) December to February (B) June to September
(C) March to May (D) October to November

> **Ans: (B)** It brings about three-fourths of India's annual rainfall.

(vi) Pilgrims who walk to Pandharpur in Maharashtra take part in the —

(A) Kanwar Yatra (B) Rath Yatra (C) Wari (D) Amarnath Yatra

> **Ans: (C)** The Wari honours Vitthal, with warkaris walking from Alandi and Dehu.

(vii) The early capital of Magadha was —

(A) Shravasti (B) Ujjayini (C) Taxila (D) Rajagriha

> **Ans: (D)** It was later shifted to Pataliputra.

(viii) The National Emblem of India is adapted from the Lion Capital of Ashoka at —

(A) Sanchi (B) Bodh Gaya (C) Sarnath (D) Nalanda

> **Ans: (C)** The capital stood on an Ashokan pillar at Sarnath.

(ix) Which Kushana ruler was a great patron of Buddhism and of Gandhara and Mathura art?

(A) Kanishka (B) Gautamiputra Satakarni

(C) Kharavela (D) Pushyamitra Shunga

> **Ans: (A)** Kanishka ruled from Purushapura and Mathura.

(x) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.

Statement I: Samudragupta's achievements are described in the Prayaga Prashasti, inscribed on an Ashokan pillar.

Statement II: The Arthashastra was written by the poet Kalidasa.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct

(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Statement II is wrong: the Arthashastra was composed by Kautilya (Chanakya).

(xi) In the ancient gana-sanghas (republics), decisions were taken by —

(A) a single hereditary king (B) priests only

(C) foreign rulers (D) assemblies of the people or their leaders

> **Ans: (D)** Vajji and Malla were governed by assemblies.

(xii) The word 'secular' in the Preamble means that the State —

(A) supports only the majority religion

(B) has no official religion and treats all religions equally

(C) bans all religions

(D) controls all temples

> **Ans: (B)** India respects all faiths equally.

(xiii) Identify the correct match.

(A) Article 21A – Right to Equality

(B) Article 21A – Right to Education (free and compulsory, ages 6–14)

(C) Article 21A – Freedom of speech

(D) Article 21A – Right against Exploitation

> **Ans: (B)** Article 21A makes education a Fundamental Right for children aged 6–14.

(xiv) Rishi pays ₹ 50 for lunch by scanning a QR code on his phone. This is an example of —

(A) barter (B) a stock-market deal

(C) a government grant (D) a digital payment

> **Ans: (D)** Digital payment moves money electronically between bank accounts.

(xv) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.

When the price of a good falls (other things remaining the same), the quantity demanded generally .....

(A) rises (B) falls (C) stays the same (D) becomes zero

> **Ans: (A)** A lower price encourages more buyers to purchase.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) State any two ways in which a weather forecast helps farmers or fishermen.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Farmers can decide when to sow, irrigate or harvest
> - Warnings of heavy rain/cyclone help save crops and cattle
> - Fishermen avoid going to the sea during storms
> - Helps in protecting life and property (any two, 1 mark each)

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2.(B) What is a rain gauge? What does it measure?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A cylindrical vessel with a funnel and a measuring scale to collect rain — 1 mark
> - It measures rainfall in millimetres (or cm) — 1 mark

3. Why are the Northern Plains very fertile and thickly populated?

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Fertile alluvial soil deposited by rivers like the Ganga and Indus
> - Flat land is suitable for farming, roads, railways and cities
> - Water is available from rivers throughout the year (any two, 1 mark each)

4.(A) Name any two sources from which we know about Ashoka.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Ashoka's edicts on rocks and pillars
> - Buddhist texts such as the Ashokavadana and the Sri Lankan chronicles
> - Sculptures such as the Sarnath lion capital
> - Archaeological remains of Pataliputra (any two, 1 mark each)

O R

4.(B) Who were the dhamma mahamattas? State one duty.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Special officers appointed by Ashoka to spread dhamma — 1 mark
> - They looked after the welfare of people of all communities — 1 mark

5.(A) What is universal adult franchise? At what age can an Indian citizen vote?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - The right of every adult citizen to vote without discrimination — 1 mark
> - At the age of 18 years — 1 mark

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5.(B) State any two differences between a monarchy and a democracy.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Monarchy: ruler by birth; democracy: leaders elected by people
> - Monarchy: ruler need not answer to people; democracy: government accountable
> - Democracy ensures equal voting rights (any two, 1 mark each)

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of Kushana rule.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Kanishka, the most famous Kushana king, ruled over north-west India and Central Asia
- They controlled the Silk Route, which brought wealth through trade
- Issued fine gold coins with images of gods and kings
- Supported Buddhism; the Gandhara and Mathura schools of art developed
- Convened a Buddhist council (traditionally in Kashmir)

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6.(B) Explain any three features of the trade of the Sangam age.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Ports like Muziris and Arikamedu traded with Rome and Southeast Asia
- Exports included pepper, pearls, cotton cloth, spices and ivory
- Roman gold coins were found in southern India
- Merchant guilds supported trade
- It added to the wealth of Chola, Chera and Pandya kingdoms

7.(A) Describe any three features of the hot weather season (summer) in north India.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Temperatures rise sharply from March to May, often above 45 °C
- Hot, dry winds called 'loo' blow in the afternoon
- Dust storms and thunderstorms occur (Kal Baisakhi in the east)
- Low pressure develops over the north-west, drawing in the monsoon
- Pre-monsoon showers such as 'mango showers' occur in the south

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7.(B) Describe the retreating monsoon season (October–November) in India with three features.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- The southwest monsoon withdraws from the north-west and then from the entire country
- Skies become clear but the weather is hot and humid ('October heat')
- Cyclones form in the Bay of Bengal and strike the east coast
- Tamil Nadu receives most of its rain from the north-east/retreating monsoon

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain any five characteristics of the cities that developed in the Second Urbanisation (c. 600 BCE).

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- They grew in the Ganga plains and on trade routes with fertile land
- Strong fortification walls and moats with gates
- The use of iron tools improved farming and supported large populations
- Craftsmen, traders and guilds (shrenis) lived in the cities
- Punch-marked coins were used for trade
- Rulers lived there and collected taxes
- Cities such as Rajagriha, Shravasti and Kaushambi were famous

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8.(B) Explain the seven limbs (saptanga) of the Mauryan state described in the Arthashastra (any five).

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Swami — the king
- Amatya — ministers/officials
- Janapada — territory and people
- Durga — fort
- Kosha — treasury
- Danda — army/force
- Mitra — allies

9.(A) Explain the three levels of government in India (Union, State and Local) with one function of each.

Marking points:

- Union (Centre) — Parliament; subjects like defence, foreign policy, currency (2 marks)
- State — State Legislative Assembly; subjects like police, public health, agriculture (1.5 marks)
- Local — Panchayats and municipalities; village/town services like roads, water, sanitation (1.5 marks)

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9.(B) Explain any five Fundamental Duties and say how they help in making a better country.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Respect the Constitution, the Flag and the Anthem
- Protect public property and avoid violence
- Protect the environment and wildlife
- Develop scientific temper and humanism
- Promote harmony and brotherhood
- Strive for excellence in individual and collective activity
- Duties balance rights and strengthen the nation

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

Savita, a farmer from a village near Jaipur, brings vegetables to the weekly haat every Thursday. She sets up a small stall and sells directly to customers. She does not pay shop rent and can fix her price after seeing what others are charging. Customers like the haat because vegetables are fresh and prices can be bargained.

(10.1) Who is the seller and who are the buyers in the haat?

Savita is the seller; the customers are the buyers.

(10.2) Name one advantage for the farmer of selling directly in a weekly haat.

No middlemen/shop rent; she earns the full price; direct contact with buyers (any one).

(10.3) Why do prices in a haat change from week to week?

(1) Supply of vegetables changes with seasons, weather and harvest; (1) demand and competition among sellers change the price (bargaining).

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In May 2019, Cyclone Fani approached the Odisha coast. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) tracked the cyclone with satellites and radar and gave timely warnings. The state government moved about 12 lakh people to safe shelters before it struck, which kept the loss of lives very low.

(11.1) Which department gave the cyclone warnings?

> The India Meteorological Department (IMD).

(11.2) Name any one instrument/technology used to track the cyclone.

> Satellites or radar (also weather balloons, ocean buoys).

(11.3) How can weather forecasts reduce the damage caused by natural disasters?

> (1) Early warning allows people to move to safe places and secure property; (1) farmers, fishermen, transport and authorities can plan and prepare in advance.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The Chinese Buddhist monk Faxian travelled across India around 400 CE during the reign of Chandragupta II. He visited Buddhist holy places and monasteries, stayed for years at Pataliputra, studied Sanskrit and copied manuscripts. He wrote that the people were prosperous and that roads were safe.

(12.1) Who was Faxian?

> A Chinese Buddhist monk who travelled in India.

(12.2) Which Gupta ruler was on the throne at the time?

> Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

(12.3) Why are accounts of foreign travellers useful to historians? Give two reasons.

> (1) They give an outsider's description of society, administration, trade and religion; (1) they help cross-check or add to evidence from inscriptions, coins and Indian texts.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The Preamble begins with the words 'We, the people of India' and declares India to be a sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic. It aims to secure for all citizens justice, liberty, equality and to promote fraternity so that the dignity of the individual and the unity of the nation are assured.

(13.1) With which words does the Preamble begin?

> 'We, the people of India'.

(13.2) Name any two ideals which the Preamble aims to secure for all citizens.

> Any two of: justice, liberty, equality, fraternity.

(13.3) What does the word 'republic' mean?

> (1) The head of state is elected, not hereditary; (1) power rests with the people, not with a king or queen.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Jaisalmer
(II) Mathura
(III) Bhubaneswar
(IV) Madurai
(V) Mumbai
(VI) Srinagar

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jaisalmer located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Mathura located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bhubaneswar located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Madurai located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Mumbai located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Srinagar located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Jaisalmer — **Rajasthan**
- (II) Mathura — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (III) Bhubaneswar — **Odisha**
- (IV) Madurai — **Tamil Nadu**
- (V) Mumbai — **Maharashtra**
- (VI) Srinagar — **Jammu and Kashmir (UT)**

